

Last-Gen Garmin & Coros Sports Watches — AU Prices

Software & experience: Garmin vs Coros for a female Ironman athlete

Garmin

- **Interface:** touchscreen + 5 buttons on the AMOLED models; highly customisable data screens, watch faces and Connect IQ apps.
- **Triathlon:** mature multisport/triathlon profiles with transitions, open-water swim, and the widest bike-sensor support (power meters, Edge bike computers, Varia radar).
- **Coaching:** Training Readiness, HRV status, recovery time and daily suggested workouts on the watch; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** long-established menstrual cycle and pregnancy tracking in Garmin Connect, with phase-based training tips.
- **Everyday:** Garmin Pay, richer notifications; app can feel busy.

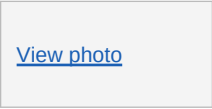
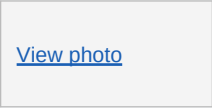
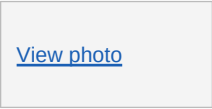
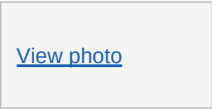
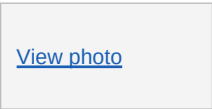
Coros

- **Interface:** buttons + digital crown (touch mainly for maps); simple, fast and glove/wet-hand friendly, but fewer customisation options.
- **Triathlon:** solid triathlon mode with transitions and open-water swim; fewer bike-sensor features than Garmin.
- **Coaching:** free Training Hub web platform with strong load/fatigue analytics and structured workouts; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** menstrual cycle tracking added Oct 2025 – predictions on the training calendar, watch reminders on every Coros model listed.
- **Everyday:** no payments, basic smart features; much longer battery for the money.

For Ironman racing: plan for up to the 17-hour cut-off. Most watches here cover that in full GPS. The **Forerunner 265** manages 14 h in multi-band mode, so race in SatIQ (16 h) or GPS-only (20 h); the **Forerunner 165** manages 19 h but has no multi-band. For comfort over a long day, the Fenix 8 47mm and Vertix 2S are the heaviest; the Forerunner 265S, 965, Pace 3 and Pace Pro sit better on smaller wrists. **Best all-round picks:** Forerunner 965 (maps, AMOLED, light, ~\$699 on Amazon) or, on a budget, Coros Pace Pro (~\$565) / Pace 3 (~\$430).

"Last gen" = the model each brand has since replaced (as of 9 Oct 2026). Prices are the most recent AU listings found via price-comparison sites; retailer sites could not be checked directly, so confirm before buying. "Not listed" means no current listing was found.

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Garmin Fenix 8 (47mm AMOLED) 2024 flagship · replaced by Fenix 9 (Aug 2026) View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not listed Amazon AU: \$1,347 (RRP \$1,699)	• Bright AMOLED, leak-proof buttons • Built-in speaker/mic: voice commands, calls • Full offline topo maps • 40m dive rating • Titanium/sapphire options	• Expensive, even discounted • Heavy and bulky for running • Fenix 9 now brighter, 50% more RAM • Shorter battery than MIP versions	HR: Elevate Gen 5 optical ECG: Yes – AFib app approved in AU SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Depth sensor (40m), ambient light, mic
Garmin Epix Pro (Gen 2) 47mm 2023 · replaced by Fenix 8 AMOLED View photo	Kogan: Not listed now (was \$699 EOFY deal) JB Hi-Fi: Not listed now (was \$1,349 Sapphire, 2024) Amazon AU: \$762 (seen \$722–\$812)	• AMOLED + built-in LED flashlight • Full maps, multi-band GPS • Big discounts where still stocked • Same training features as Fenix 7 Pro	• Being cleared out – stock is scarce • No speaker/mic, no dive depth sensor • Buttons not leak-proof • Battery well below MIP Fenix	HR: Elevate Gen 5 optical ECG: Hardware capable; app not approved for this model in AU (2025) SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light, LED flashlight

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Garmin Forerunner 965 2023 · replaced by Forerunner 970 (2025)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not listed Amazon AU: \$698.84 (RRP \$999)	• AMOLED, light (~53g) with titanium bezel • Full maps + multi-band GPS • Training Readiness, HRV, race predictor • Strong battery for an AMOLED	• Plastic case feels less premium • No flashlight, speaker or ECG (970 has all) • Older HR sensor than 970 • Now hard to find new in AU	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light
Garmin Forerunner 265 2023 · replaced by Forerunner 570 (2025)  View photo	Kogan: 265S only: \$572 (Aug 2026) JB Hi-Fi: 265S only: \$499 sale (was \$799, undated) Amazon AU: \$699 (dips to ~\$498 on deals)	• AMOLED touchscreen at mid-range price • Multi-band GPS • Training Readiness, HRV status, onboard music • Two sizes (265 / 265S)	• No maps (breadcrumb only) • Battery shorter than 965 • No flashlight/speaker/ECG • Standard 46mm size getting scarce	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light
Garmin Forerunner 165 2024 · replaced by Forerunner 170 (May 2026)  View photo	Kogan: \$329 (Jul 2026, may be out of stock) JB Hi-Fi: Not listed Amazon AU: \$399 (seen \$330–\$348)	• Cheapest AMOLED Garmin runner • Very light (~39g) • HRV status, Garmin Coach plans • Music version available	• No multi-band GPS • No Training Readiness / load focus • No maps • Battery ~11 days	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Single-band multi-GNSS Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / not confirmed Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light
Coros Pace Pro 2024 · replaced by Pace 4 Pro (Sep 2026)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$565 (list \$649.95)	• AMOLED + offline maps at a Forerunner 265 price • Excellent battery for AMOLED • Dual-frequency GPS • Light, free training platform	• Thicker than rivals • Smaller app/watch-face ecosystem than Garmin • No contactless payments • Superseded by Pace 4 Pro	HR: Coros optical (updated) ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –
Coros Pace 3 2023 · replaced by Pace 4 (Oct 2025)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$429.95	• Ultralight (~30g) • Long battery (~24 days) • Dual-frequency GPS for the price • Cheapest serious running watch here	• MIP display, less vivid • No maps • Plastic build • No payments, limited smart features	HR: Coros optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Coros Apex 2 Pro 2022 · replaced by Apex 4 (Oct 2025) View photo	Kogan: \$820 (Aug 2026) JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: Currently unavailable	• Titanium + sapphire build • Very long battery (~30 days) • Offline topo maps • Dual-frequency GPS	• MIP display • Oldest hardware in this list • Kogan price is high for its age • No payments, limited apps	HR: Coros optical ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –
Coros Vertix 2S 2024 flagship · successor not yet confirmed View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$1,149.95	• Huge battery – weeks of use, days of GPS • Offline maps, titanium/sapphire • Dual-frequency GPS • Built for ultras and expeditions	• Large and heavy (~90g) • MIP display • Pricey • No payments	HR: Coros optical ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: LED flashlight

Photos: this environment blocks image downloads, so each model links to a photo search instead. Prices gathered 9 Oct 2026 from search snapshots; dates show when a price was last seen where known (Amazon snapshot dates unknown). Amazon prices link to the listing. Coros "ECG" electrodes are used for HRV readings, not medical AFib detection.